NO. 17 英単語はいくつあるか(1)

English is a language with an enormous number of words, but how many English words are there? Most dictionaries used by college students have about 200,000 words, while most full-length dictionaries have about 300,000 to 600,000. Meanwhile, an organization called the Global Language Monitor positively claims that there are exactly 1,019,729 English words.

But counting the number of words in English is not an easy task. First of all, many words that we use in English today were originally words in other languages. Should the words sushi or tsunami be considered English words now that they are frequently used? Then there is the question of words that were used centuries ago but are no longer used today. Should they be counted too? What about words that are only used in certain regions of a country?

1	enormous	形容詞	莫大な・巨大な
2	tremendous	形容詞	(強さなどが)ものすごい・素晴らしい
3	college	名詞	(単科)大学
4	length	名詞	(物や時間の)長さ
5	span	名詞	(時間の)長さ・期間
6	meanwhile	副詞	一方では・その間に
7	monitor	名詞・他動詞	(監視)モニター・を監視する
8	exactly	副詞	ちょうど・正確に
9	originally	副詞	元来は・初めは
10	ancestor	名詞	先祖
11	consider	他動詞	[～AB]A を B とみなす・をよく考える
12	frequently	副詞	頻繁に
13	certain	形容詞	ある特定の・確かな
14	ensure	他動詞	を確実にする・を保証する
15	assure	他動詞	(人)に保証する・を安心させる
16	reassure	他動詞	を安心させる
17	guarantee	他動詞・名詞	を保証する・保証
18	region	名詞	地域
19	geographical	形容詞	地理的な・地理学(上)の

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